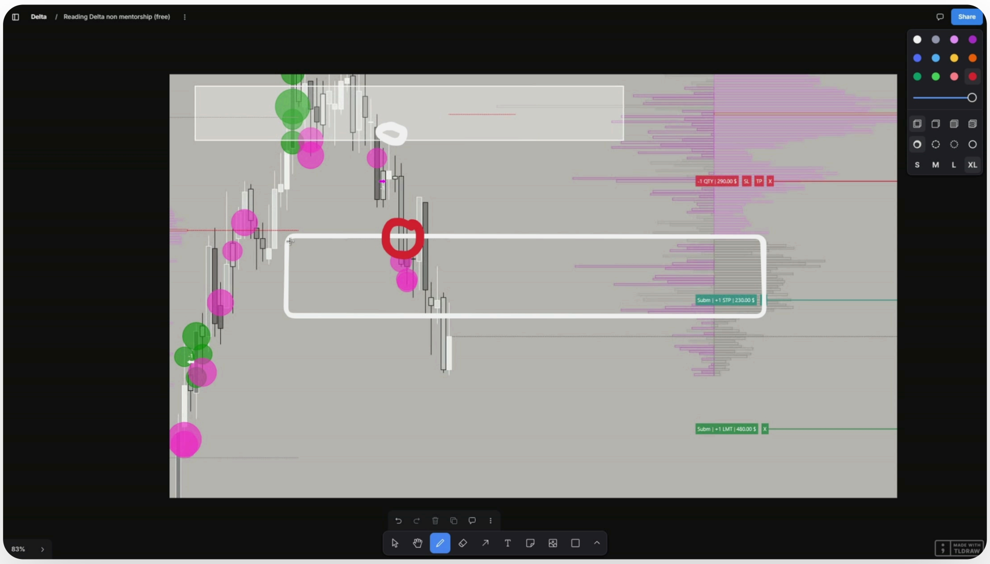
ETHOS ORDER FLOW / EDUCATION

Reading Delta

Three ways to actually use Delta: partialing, confirming reward, and reading intra-wick reactions

SIRES × ETHOS ORDER FLOW



DELTA · 3 METHODS · REAL TRADE TICKETS · 11 PAGES

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Why partialing beats a fixed breakeven

the prop firm EV argument underneath all three methods

This document is built around three specific, repeatable ways to use Delta in a live trade, not a general explanation of what Delta is. Each one answers a different question: where do I take partials and move my stop, is this aggression actually going to pay, and where can I expect a clean reaction on a lower timeframe.

The framing underneath method one matters on its own. On a prop firm account, moving straight to breakeven the moment a trade works caps the trade at zero if it comes back, and simply jumping straight to breakeven repeatedly is, in his own words, probably the worst thing you can do for your EV. The alternative isn't holding for the full target either: it's partialing at logical points Delta actually gives you, moving the stop up behind each one, so a give-back costs you less than the full round trip and a continuation still pays.

This is intentionally basic. His own description of method one: extremely basic, but simple enough that it directly changes how a trade is managed, not just how it's entered.

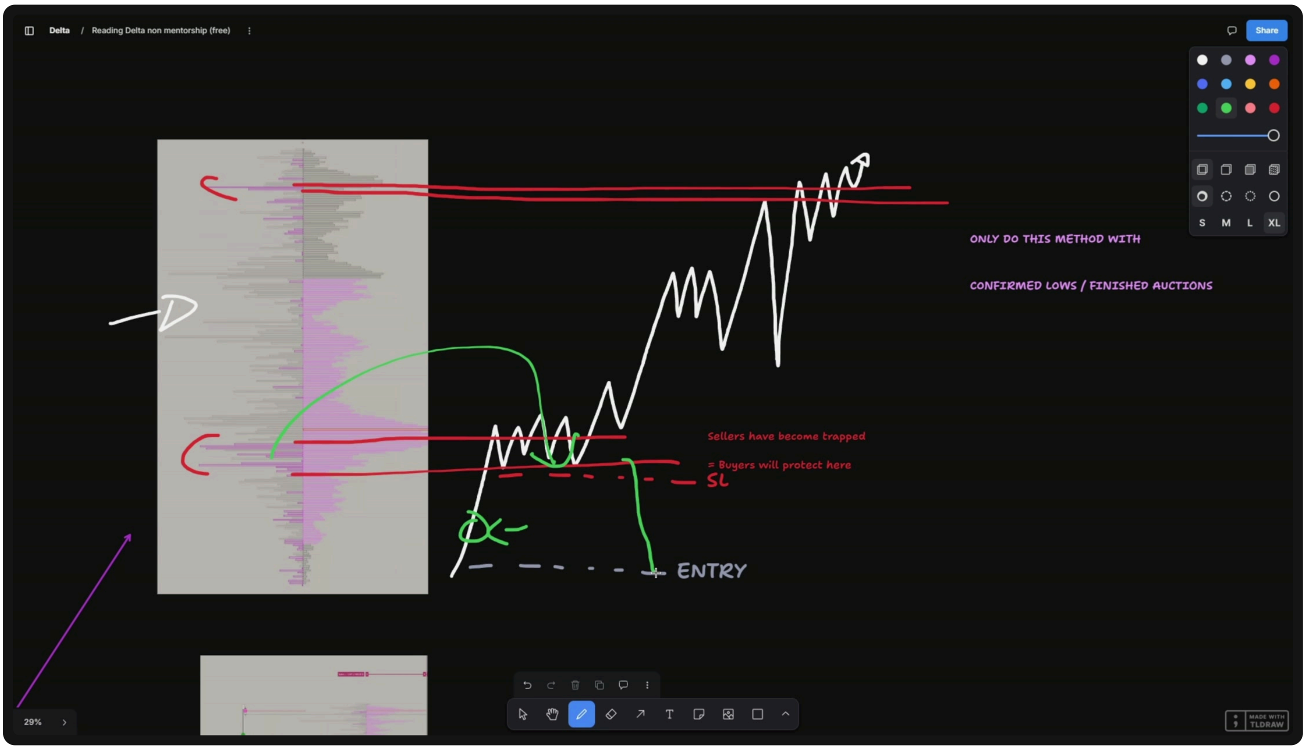
Method 1: reading the protected low

using Delta to know exactly where to partial and trail your stop

The setup: price is going up, you're long, and the Delta profile shows a clear imbalance of buying aggression over selling at the recent low, enough that the sellers there are effectively trapped, fuel for the move higher rather than a real fight. Price forms a small balance and escapes it. Once that low is confirmed and price stops coming back to test it, that low becomes what he calls a protected low.

The rule for using it: partial below that micro balance, specifically below the sellers who defended it. This is the last point where sellers could still logically defend. If price goes below that point, the read is no longer "these sellers failed," it's "these sellers are refilling and pushing back down toward your entry," a genuinely different trade. Only apply this to confirmed lows and finished auctions, never a level that's still being formed.

THE PROTECTED LOW: PARTIAL BELOW WHERE SELLERS COULD STILL DEFEND



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A second example, trailed live

the same read repeated, protected low after protected low

Walked through on a real trade: entered long, initial stop set wide below entry. Once buying aggression showed up with a clear last line of defense underneath it, the read was that a break below those buyers would send price traversing all the way back down into range, where the aggressive sellers from earlier would themselves be absorbed and buyers would regain control. Stop moved to just below that wick low, entered there.

From there it's the same operation repeated: retest the area, price pushes back up, trail the stop below the new protected low. Repeat again at the next one. Each protected low is a place where, if price comes down to it, the buyers sitting there are expected to defend and push price back up. If price instead breaks through the highest-Delta protected low on the chart, that's the signal the trade is more likely traversing to the stop than continuing, and the honest answer at that point is to accept the drawdown rather than fight it. You can always re-enter.

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Method 2: is the aggression actually being rewarded

the wick trap, and why the highest Delta print outweighs it

The second method is a confirmation check most beginners skip. Buying aggression printing on a wick looks, on its own, like buyers are being absorbed, the textbook setup for a short. His own description of the trap: a lot of beginners would enter shorts there, assuming the sellers who showed up are the ones being rewarded.

The correction is to check where the highest point of the Delta profile actually sits, not just where the most recent print is. If that highest point is buyers, not the sellers who just showed up on the wick, the read flips: buyers defended quickly, a meaningful amount of buying aggression came in, and price is more likely to push higher again, not lower. The sell aggression was real. It just wasn't the side that got rewarded.

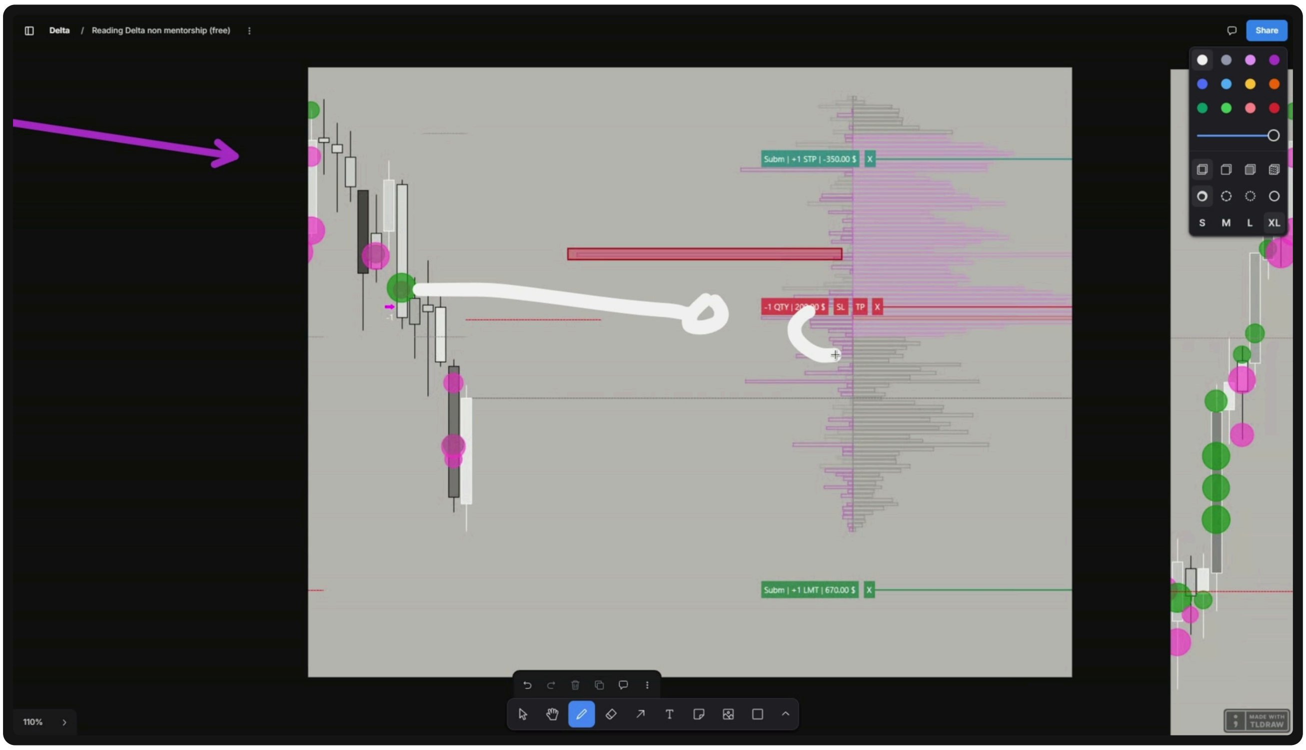
07 The delta print, on a real order ticket

reading the highest point on the profile against an actual short

He calls the highest point on the Delta profile a delta print, and treats it as the single most load-bearing piece of information on the chart: whichever side produced it is the side that was rewarded. On the trade shown, that highest print is sell aggression, and it lines up with a short entered right there, stop and target both placed off real levels rather than a fixed distance.

What happens next follows directly from the print: buyers who were active earlier get trapped as more sellers regain control, visible as what he calls a sell bubble. Price pushes to target. From here the same trailing logic from method one applies again: if buyers show up again on a retest, the stop can move above that new print rather than sitting static.

THE HIGHEST DELTA PRINT ON THE PROFILE, AGAINST A REAL SHORT: ENTRY, STOP AND TARGET



The order tickets are real fills from the trade, shown to make the point concrete rather than as a promise of what any single trade pays.

08

The refill schematic

control changing hands twice, and why it matters for the next entry

The trade above is also an example of what he calls the refill concept, covered in more depth in a separate video on his channel about a scalping strategy he says carries a 98 percent pass rate. That figure belongs to that video, not this document, it's referenced here only to point at where the fuller explanation lives.

The short version relevant to Delta specifically: buyers who had result once will, if the setup repeats, tend to have result again, and the sellers opposing them get trapped, exhausted, or absorbed, whichever term you prefer for the same outcome. On the trade shown, sellers who had been absorbed on the way up eventually got rewarded, confirmed by their own delta print, and price refilled from a state of "buyers have no result" to "sellers do," pushing lower with the previously-trapped buyers now the side being absorbed.

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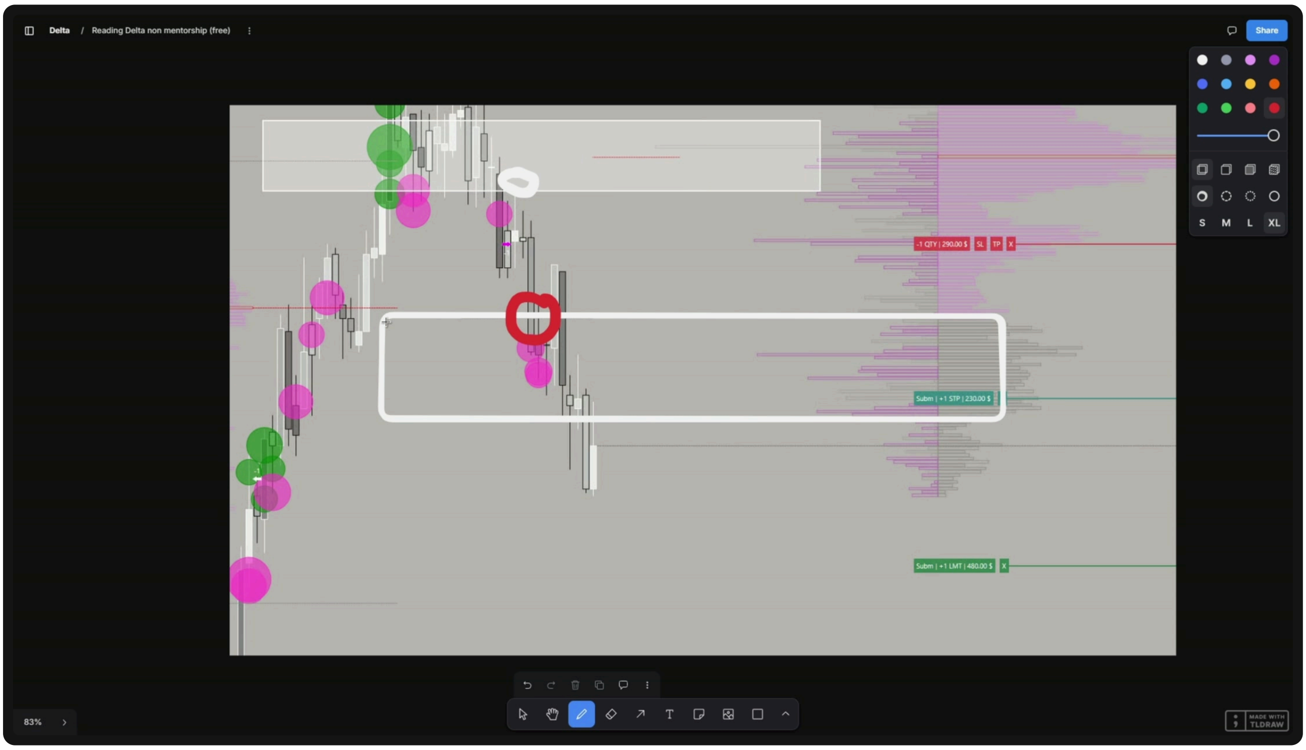
Method 3: Delta prints as intra-wick reactions

pairing a high Delta print with a real VP extreme

The third method, by his own account rarely discussed elsewhere: pairing a large area of Delta with an extreme on the volume profile, specifically a low volume node or minor volume node, and using that pairing to find repeatable intra-wick reactions on a lower timeframe.

The pattern: draw out the low or minor volume node from the dealing range's own VP. A large Delta print sitting right at that extreme tends to produce a clean wick reaction, price tags the level and rejects, repeatedly, at both the top and bottom of the same micro balance. On the trade shown, a large amount of buying Delta gets trapped by sellers arriving right after it, at a minor volume node extreme, and the resulting short runs cleanly to target with more than one wick reaction visible along the way once the zone is drawn out properly.

A LOW VOLUME NODE EXTREME, A HIGH DELTA PRINT, AND THE WICK REACTION IT PRODUCED



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The checklist

every rule in this document, printable

METHOD 1: PARTIALING OFF THE PROTECTED LOW

- [ ] This low or high is confirmed, price has stopped retesting it, not still forming.
- [ ] I'm partialing below the specific sellers (or above the specific buyers) who last defended it, not an arbitrary distance.
- [ ] I'm trailing the stop behind each new protected level as it forms, not jumping straight to breakeven.

METHOD 2: CONFIRMING THE REWARD

- [ ] I've checked the highest point on the Delta profile, not just the most recent print, before assuming which side is trapped.
- [ ] If the highest Delta point contradicts the wick I was about to trade against, I default to the Delta print.

METHOD 3: INTRA-WICK REACTIONS

- [ ] I've paired the large Delta print with a real VP extreme, a low or minor volume node, not a random price.
- [ ] I've checked whether this level has produced more than one wick reaction, not just the one I'm looking at.

Same profile.
Three different questions to ask it.

Where to partial and trail. Whether the aggression you're reading was actually rewarded. Where a high Delta print, paired with a real VP extreme, produces a repeatable reaction. None of the three needs a different tool, only a different question asked of the one you already have open.

Every one of these read live, on real trades, inside the mentorship.

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